

Chapter 26 - Acquaintance

Feng Yue's decisiveness was something Yan Lin hadn't expected. She stood there helplessly, with those vague gazes from behind piercing her like thorns. They didn't hurt, but they were impossible to ignore.

For the first time, Yan Lin hated herself so intensely—hated her past blindness, hated that she had lost her most precious thing.

Yan Lin raised her head, looking resolutely at Feng Yue's back as she melted into the crowd. She put down what she was holding and strode after her.

Since she wanted to start over with Feng Yue, she would keep chasing in Feng Yue's footsteps, no matter where, no matter when.

Feng Yue walked into the crowd, naturally aware of the gazes falling on her like thorns in her back.

After staying for a while, Feng Yue felt uncomfortable all over, so she hurriedly left again. Only when she pushed open the banquet hall doors and came to a small garden behind did she breathe a sigh of relief.

There were almost no people in the small garden, just a small musical fountain working tirelessly in the distance. She found a bench in front of the fountain to sit on, tilted her head slightly to look at the ink-black sky without a trace of starlight, and let out a long sigh.

She hadn't expected to encounter Yan Lin here. Having stayed by Yan Lin's side for so many years, she was quite clear about the Yan family's customs. Although this kind of full moon celebration would send invitation letters to the Yan family, they would never attend.

It was precisely because of this that Feng Yue had agreed to come along with her parents.

In the end, she hadn't managed to relax and had encountered someone who gave her trouble.

Feng Yue was wearing a short-sleeved black velvet dress today, with slightly curled long hair flowing behind her. At this moment, when the breeze in the small garden blew, she felt a hint of coolness.

The situation wasn't good—she hadn't eaten much tonight.

The hunger that emerged when the cold wind blew made Feng Yue quite troubled. But thinking about those inexplicable gazes directed at her in the banquet hall, Feng Yue gave up the idea of going inside to find food.

She looked at the time. It wouldn't be long before she could leave. She could endure it.

Feng Yue had originally planned to quietly wait out this period, but clearly some people wouldn't let her have her way.

Feng Yue felt the light in front of her dim. She frowned and looked up to see Yan Lin standing in front of her, extending a hand with a candy lying in her palm.

It was just an ordinary candy, the kind you could casually buy a big bag of at the supermarket—a fruit-flavored hard candy. The one lying in Yan Lin's palm now had pink packaging with a picture showing the flavor: strawberry.

Feng Yue glanced at her, then turned her head away and closed her eyes. Out of sight, out of mind.

Yan Lin curled her fingers and gently clenched the candy in her palm. The serrated edge of the wrapper pressed into her palm, creating a subtle stinging sensation.

"You're angry with me, but there's no need to make things difficult for your own body." Yan Lin's voice was still flat.

Feng Yue might have been hungry for too long and felt somewhat irritable. Upon hearing Yan Lin's words, she suddenly opened her eyes, her gaze falling directly into Yan Lin's calm, emotionless eyes.

Yan Lin's hand was still extended, with the candy still lying in her palm.

Feng Yue looked at her for a while. Between ignoring her and eating a candy to comfort her stomach, she chose the latter.

Because of her long-term vomiting from medication, her stomach wasn't in good condition to begin with, so she didn't plan to torture her body.

Feng Yue put the candy in her mouth. With the sugar supplement, her stomach spasms finally improved considerably.

"Thank you, President Yan."

Yan Lin was about to say something when Feng Yue's "President Yan" choked her words back.

Feng Yue was deliberately distancing herself from their relationship.

Yan Lin clearly understood this fact.

"I—"

Before Yan Lin could finish speaking, Feng Yue stood up directly and said coldly: "President Yan, there's nothing to discuss between us. I've already said what needed to be said before. If you didn't hear it, I won't repeat it a second time. So please, President Yan, don't put on this hesitant appearance in front of me. It troubles me."

Yan Lin was so blocked by Feng Yue's words that she couldn't say anything, only standing there in a daze.

"If President Yan has nothing else, please feel free to leave. There should be many people in the banquet hall who want to chat with you." With that, Feng Yue sat back down and slowly closed her eyes.

Yan Lin looked at Feng Yue with her eyes closed, leaning back in the chair to rest. Although that face was still the one she was familiar with, the words coming from it made her feel incredibly strange.

Feng Yue closed her eyes, no longer looking at her. But her ears didn't hear the sound of Yan Lin leaving, so she knew Yan Lin hadn't left yet.

The two seemed to be in a standoff in the small garden. Apart from the sound of the fountain flowing, only their breathing could be heard.

"Yan Lin, Feng Yue?" A crisp female voice rang out in the small garden.

The two people in the standoff both looked toward the corridor beside the small garden, where a girl in a light green polka-dot chiffon camisole dress was standing, looking at them.

There was an imperceptible light flickering in her eyes.

No, this light should be flickering at Yan Lin. Feng Yue thought to herself.

The woman seemed very happy to see the two of them, so she cheerfully walked toward them.

Feng Yue somewhat irritably glared at Yan Lin's back. She just wanted to quietly endure this period, but Yan Lin always brought trouble.

This was yet another pursuer of Yan Lin appearing from who knows where.

Yan Lin seemed to sense something and turned to look at Feng Yue. Feng Yue looked as if she'd seen a ghost, seeing a trace of innocence in her eyes, which was quite nauseating.

Seeing the obviously unfamiliar looks the two were giving her, the woman didn't get angry, just smiled and said: "I'm Wang Cuili¹. Tonight's full moon celebration is for my little sister."

"Good evening, Miss Wang. Congratulations." Feng Yue stood up to congratulate her. She felt this Miss Wang looked somewhat familiar.

Yan Lin didn't speak, just followed Feng Yue's movement with a slight nod.

Feng Yue: ...

Wang Cuili's gaze wandered between the two for a moment, then she smiled again and said: "Ah, you two probably forgot. We went to the same university before—I was a year below you in the Foreign Language College."

Surname Wang, junior, Foreign Language College.

These elements combined quickly matched a figure in Feng Yue's mind.

Her former rival.

Feng Yue and Yan Lin were quite prominent figures during university, and naturally there were countless people pursuing Yan Lin. The one that left the deepest impression on Feng Yue was that department belle from the Foreign Language College.

She remembered that once when she had to ask for leave from her parents to visit her grandmother's house for a few days, and when she returned to school, she learned that during those few days, someone had made a grand confession to Yan Lin.

This person was the department belle from the Foreign Language College.

The final result naturally ended with Yan Lin's unhesitating rejection. At that time, Yan Lin had just gotten together with Feng Yue not long ago, and it was precisely because of this incident that Yan Lin proactively suggested they move off-campus.

The ecstatic Feng Yue naturally threw this department belle to the back of her mind.

Clearly, this Miss Wang was that former department belle, and Yan Lin probably hadn't recognized her yet.

Because Feng Yue heard Yan Lin say flatly: "Miss Wang, if we're not familiar, please don't address us by our first names."

Wang Cuili's expression stiffened, forcing a smile at the corners of her mouth. "Hahaha, senior sister, we're from the same school after all. Can't we be a little more intimate?"

Wang Cuili's speech carried a slight trailing tone, sounding like she was acting coquettishly. If it were an ordinary person, they would probably agree—calling someone by their name wasn't a big deal.

But Yan Lin didn't think so. She said: "We're not from the same college."

The implication was: we're not from the same college, so don't call me senior sister, and don't be intimate with me.

While Feng Yue found this amusing, she also felt somewhat surprised. She knew how well-mannered Yan Lin was. Normally, Yan Lin wouldn't mind such things and wouldn't so rudely correct someone's form of address.

Yes, Yan Lin normally wouldn't be so rude, but at this moment, Yan Lin was being this way because she had recognized Wang Cuili.

However, unlike Feng Yue's "recognition," she wasn't recalling Wang Cuili's confession to her in university, but remembering events from her previous life.

In her previous life, Feng Yue's illness was discovered because she went to the company to find Yan Lin and saw Yan Lin intimately close with someone else. Feng Yue was so stimulated that she became dizzy and fainted on the spot, directly sent to the hospital.

The person who was "intimately" close with Yan Lin was this Miss Wang Cuili.

The situation at that time wasn't actually what Feng Yue thought. Wang Cuili had come to Yan Corporation representing her father to discuss business with Yan Lin. When the two walked out of the corporation building together, Wang Cuili inexplicably threw herself at Yan Lin. Yan Lin couldn't avoid it and instinctively reached out to catch her.

And all of this was exactly what Feng Yue saw.

Yan Lin remembered that in her previous life, she had also explained this matter well to Feng Yue, and Feng Yue had expressed forgiveness.

But at this moment, seeing Wang Cuili's face, Yan Lin still instinctively wanted to keep her distance, fearing that something might happen to Feng Yue again.

Wang Cuili was made uncomfortable by Yan Lin's almost direct rejection and resistance. She opened her mouth but couldn't say anything.

Fortunately, Wang Cuili's phone rang at the right time. She smiled apologetically at the two and turned to leave.

Seeing her leave in embarrassment, Feng Yue shrugged and sat back on the bench to continue resting with her eyes closed.

Feng Yue always felt this Miss Wang looked somewhat familiar, but she clearly knew she had never seen this Foreign Language College department belle, not even in photos.

Feng Yue frowned slightly. This feeling of being both strange and familiar made her very uncomfortable.

She slowly recalled the memories in her mind. After an unknown amount of time, she suddenly opened her eyes.

She remembered.

She remembered why she felt Wang Cuili looked familiar.

The person who had stimulated her to fall ill in her previous life—wasn't it exactly this Miss Wang?

Footnotes:

¹ "Wang Cuili" (王卉礼) - This is revealed to be the full name of the character who was previously known as "Wang Xiao Jie" (Miss Wang). "Cuili" can mean "elegant and courteous," which creates irony given her manipulative behavior.